❖ Mesosphere

The region above the stratosphere is called the mesosphere. It extends upward to a height of about 85km from the ground. The temperature in this layer decreases with height and it is –1100 C. Most of the meteors found in the sky burn in this layer.

❖ Thermosphere

The layer of very rare air above the mesosphere is called the thermosphere. It is found above the mesosphere.

❖ Exosphere

The outermost layer of the atmosphere is called the exosphere. It lies between 400 - 1500 km above the earth. The air here is extremely thin.



Do you know?

As the height increases the amount of air in the atmosphere decreases and so the oxygen level will decrease. That is why mountain climbers carry oxygen cylinders while climbing mountains.



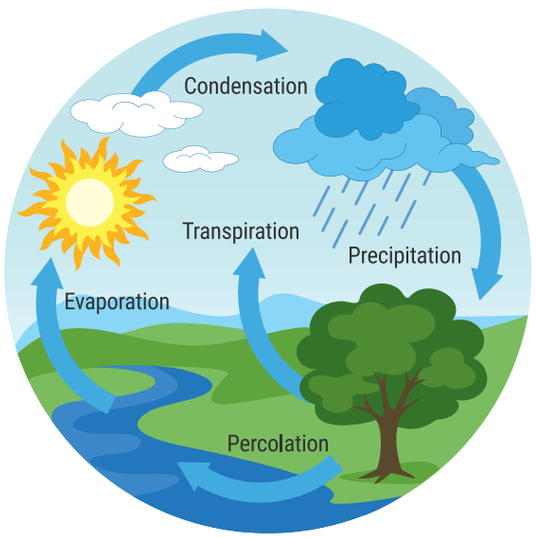


II. Importance of Air

Air is important for all the living organisms. Without air no life can exist on the earth. We take in oxygen from the air and release carbon dioxide. Plants in turn use carbon dioxide present in the air to produce their food. The gases such as oxygen, nitrogen, carbon dioxide and hydrogen present in the air are important to us for many reasons. Let us study about the importance of air in this section.

❖ Water Cycle

Water vapour present in the air is important for the formation of water cycle. Water from the water bodies such as rivers and oceans evaporates and becomes water vapour. This water vapour then forms the clouds. These clouds move to the land and get cooled to give us the rain. This movement of clouds is possible due to air.



❖ Supplies Energy

We breathe oxygen present in the air and it is supplied to the cells in our body. Body cells burn the food molecules with the help of oxygen and produce energy. With this energy we do all kinds of works.

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